

AYOLA FOODS KENYA — COMPREHENSIVE BUSINESS PLAN

Prepared for: Ayola Foods Limited **Founder/CEO:** Prisca Kiragu, Food Scientist (JKUAT) **Date:** March 2026 **Version:** 2.0 (Fact-Checked & Updated) **Classification:** For Internal Use, Investor & Grant Applications

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Opportunity

Kenya's food market is projected to reach **USD 79.3 billion by 2029** (Statista), yet the health and functional food segment remains drastically underserved — dominated by expensive imports inaccessible to most Kenyans. With **58 million people** (75% under 35), rising rates of lifestyle diseases, and exploding interest in gut health and probiotics, there is massive unmet demand for **affordable, locally produced, science-backed health foods**.

The Company

Ayola Foods Kenya is a Nairobi-based food business founded by **Prisca Kiragu**, a JKUAT-trained food scientist, combining a **full-service health-focused restaurant** with **packaged food products** shipped countrywide. Operating from Ruhan Plaza in Kahawa Sukari (Thika Road corridor), Ayola Foods specializes in:

- **Probiotic and fermented beverages** (plantain kvass, synbiotic porridge)
- **Nutritious unconventional meals** (rabbit wet fry, turkey egg combos, health-focused pilau)
- **Heritage flour blends** (special ugali blend, special uji blend)
- **Vegetarian, vegan, and gut-health-focused options**

What Makes Ayola Unique

No other food business in Kenya combines all of these under one brand:

1. A food scientist founder with genuine expertise in functional food formulation
2. Probiotic beverages (plantain kvass) — first of its kind in Kenya's food service sector
3. Both ready meals (restaurant) AND packaged products (retail/e-commerce)
4. Heritage African ingredients with modern nutritional science
5. Affordable pricing for middle-class Kenyans

Financial Overview

Metric	Current (2026)	Year 2 Target	Year 3 Target	Year 5 Target
Revenue (KES M)	~3–6M (est.)	15–25M	40–65M	120–200M
Channels	Restaurant + delivery + parcels	+ Supermarket listings + food platforms	+ Multiple locations + export pilot	+ Franchise model + full e-commerce
Products (SKUs)	~8–12	15–20	25–30	40+
Team	Small team	10–15	20–30	50–80

2. COMPANY OVERVIEW

2.1 Company Details

Field	Details
Legal Name	Ayola Foods Limited
Founder/CEO	Prisca Kiragu
Founder Credentials	Food Scientist, Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT)
Location	Ruhan Plaza, Kahawa Sukari, Ground Floor Room 23, near Quickmatt Supermarket, Thika Road, Nairobi
Phone	0713 280 550 / 0723 846 724
Email	ayola.foods.kenya@gmail.com
Facebook	facebook.com/Ayola-Foods-Kenya (~1,471 likes)
Instagram	@ayolafoods
TikTok	@priscakiragu (founder personal)
Operating Since	~2024
Business Type	Full-service restaurant + packaged food manufacturer
Tagline	"Eat Healthy, Enjoy Life"

2.2 Business Model

Ayola Foods operates a **dual-revenue model** — combining food service with consumer packaged goods:

REVENUE STREAMS:

- └─ 1. Restaurant Walk-In Sales 50-60%
| (Ready meals, combos, beverages)
- └─ 2. Delivery & WhatsApp Orders 20-30%
| (Nairobi delivery)
- └─ 3. Packaged Product Sales 10-15%
| (Ugali blend, uji blend, flour blends)
- └─ 4. Countrywide Parcel Shipping 5-10%
| (Packaged products shipped nationwide)
- └─ 5. Future: Supermarket/Retail TBD
| (Expansion target)

2.3 Strategic Location

Kahawa Sukari is one of Nairobi's **fastest-growing residential areas** along the Thika Superhighway corridor:

- Large population of young professionals and families
- Near major institutions (Kenyatta University, JKUAT, USIU)
- Growing middle class with health-conscious demographics
- Easy access via Thika Road — connects to all of Nairobi
- Quickmatt Supermarket nearby — foot traffic and visibility

3. VISION, MISSION & VALUES

3.1 Vision

"To be Kenya's leading health food brand — proving that nutritious food can be delicious, affordable, and rooted in African heritage."

3.2 Mission

To create and serve innovative, science-backed health foods that improve gut health, nourish bodies, and celebrate African culinary heritage — making functional nutrition accessible to everyday Kenyans through our restaurant, packaged products, and educational content.

3.3 Core Values

Value	Description
Science-Led (Sayansi)	Every product is formulated by a food scientist with genuine nutritional purpose
Gut Health First	We prioritize digestive wellness through probiotics, fermentation, and functional ingredients
Heritage Innovation	We reimagine traditional African foods with modern food science
Affordable Wellness	Health food should not be a luxury — we price for everyday Kenyans
Transparency	We educate customers about ingredients, benefits, and food science through social media
Community	We build relationships with customers, farmers, and the Kahawa Sukari community

4. PRODUCTS & SERVICES

4.1 Ready Meals & Combos (Restaurant / Delivery)

Product	Description	Approx. Price (KES)
Pilau Combo	Recently reintroduced, spiced up — served with sides	500–800
Rabbit Wet Fry Combo	Rabbit wet fry with greens + Ayola special ugali	600–900
Turkey Eggs + Toasted Bread + Afkeido	Unconventional protein combo with mixed sides	500–700
Breakfast Options	Various healthy breakfast combos	300–600
Heavy Meal Options	Full lunch/dinner combos	500–1,000
Vegetarian/Vegan Options	Plant-based meal combos	400–700

All meals emphasize nutrition, gut health, and unconventional ingredient combinations.

4.2 Probiotic Beverages

Product	Description	Key Benefit
Plantain Probiotic Kvass	Fermented plantain beverage — first of its kind in Kenya	Gut health, probiotics, prebiotics
Synbiotic Porridge	Fermented porridge combining probiotics + prebiotics	Digestive health, immune support
Goat Milk / Goat Milk Tea	Fresh goat milk and chai	Easier to digest than cow milk, rich in nutrients
Special Uji/Porridge	Health-focused porridge beverages	Heritage nutrition, energy, fortification

4.3 Packaged Products (Retail / Countrywide Shipping)

Product	Size	Price (KES)	Description
Ayola Special Ugali Blend	TBD	250	Proprietary flour blend for healthier ugali
Ayola Special Uji Blend	TBD	600	Premium porridge flour with health-focused formulation
Custom Flour Blends	Varies	Varies	Specialty blends — customers use for healthier bread, baking

4.4 Product Development Pipeline

Future Product	Timeline	Opportunity
Bottled Plantain Kvass (retail)	6–12 months	Shelf-stable probiotic beverage for supermarket distribution
Synbiotic Porridge Sachets	6–12 months	Single-serve, ready-to-mix — ideal for nationwide shipping
Ayola Spice Blends	12–18 months	Signature seasoning blends from restaurant recipes
Frozen Ready Meals	18–24 months	Restaurant favorites in frozen format for retail
Goat Milk Products	18–24 months	Value-added goat milk (yogurt, flavored)

5. MARKET OPPORTUNITY

(Full analysis in separate Market Research Report — key highlights below)

5.1 Addressable Market

Market Level	Size	Description
Total Addressable Market (TAM)	USD 79.3B by 2029	Kenya's total food market
Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)	~USD 1–2B	Health foods + food service in Nairobi + packaged heritage foods
Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) Year 1	~KES 5–10M	Current restaurant + delivery + packaged products
SOM Year 3 Target	~KES 40–65M	Multi-channel (restaurant + retail + e-commerce + delivery platforms)

5.2 Why Now?

1. **Gut health is the #1 global food trend** — Kenya is 2–3 years behind the global curve; first-mover advantage is available now
2. **Post-COVID health awareness** has permanently shifted consumer behavior toward nutritious food
3. **Thika Road corridor** is experiencing rapid residential growth — Kahawa Sukari's customer base is expanding
4. **Government policy** favors value-added agricultural products and local manufacturing
5. **Social media** makes customer education and brand building cost-effective

6. MARKETING & SALES STRATEGY

6.1 Current Marketing (Working Well)

Channel	Activity	Status
Facebook Page (~1,471 likes)	Menu posts, CEO cooking demos, reels, customer engagement	Active, primary channel
Instagram (@ayolafoods)	Product reels, meal combos, beverage features	Active
Instagram (@priscakiragu)	Founder personal brand, health education, cooking demos	Active, high engagement
TikTok (@priscakiragu)	Short-form video content, recipes, restaurant snapshots	Active
WhatsApp (0713 280 550)	Direct ordering, customer communication	Active, high conversion
Word of mouth	Customer referrals, community presence in Kahawa Sukari	Organic growth

6.2 Marketing Strategy — Scale-Up Plan

Phase 1: Strengthen Digital Presence (0–6 months)

- **Launch website** (now built — ayola-foods-ke.vercel.app) with full product catalog, blog, and online ordering
- **Consistent content calendar:** 5–7 posts/week across Facebook, Instagram, TikTok
- **Educational content series:** "Gut Health 101," "Why Plantain Kvass?," "Science of Synbiotic Porridge"
- **Customer testimonials and UGC** (user-generated content) campaigns
- **Google My Business** listing for local search visibility

Phase 2: Expand Reach (6–12 months)

- **List on Glovo and Bolt Food** for Nairobi delivery
- **Influencer partnerships:** 10–15 Nairobi food/health influencers
- **In-store sampling** at Quickmatt and local events
- **SEO-optimized blog** driving organic traffic (recipes, health articles)

Phase 3: Brand Building (12–24 months)

- **Supermarket sampling events** for packaged products
- **PR and media features** (Daily Nation, Business Daily, food blogs)
- **Corporate wellness partnerships** (office health food programs)
- **Podcast/video series** on gut health and African food science

6.3 Sales Channels — Growth Plan

Channel	Current	12-Month Target	24-Month Target
Restaurant (walk-in)	Active	Optimize + expand hours	Consider 2nd location
WhatsApp/phone delivery	Active	Systemize with delivery partner	Full delivery coverage Nairobi
Facebook/Instagram	Active	Formalize as sales channel	Scale with ads
Website (D2C)	Just launched	Integrate M-Pesa checkout	Full e-commerce store
Food delivery platforms	Not listed	Glovo + Bolt Food	All platforms + corporate orders
Supermarkets	Not yet	Quickmatt (local) + 2 chains pilot	20–50 stores
Countrywide parcels	Active (informal)	Formalize with G4S/Sendy/Posta	Scale to 100+ orders/month
Export	Not yet	—	EAC pilot + diaspora D2C

7. OPERATIONS PLAN

7.1 Current Operations

Element	Current Status
Kitchen	Commercial kitchen at Ruhan Plaza, Kahawa Sukari
Type	Full-service restaurant (walk-in + delivery)
Hours	Active during meal service hours
Ordering	Walk-in, phone/WhatsApp, social media
Delivery	Self-managed, Nairobi area
Packaged products	Produced on-site, shipped countrywide via parcels
Team	Small team led by founder Prisca Kiragu

7.2 Scaling Operations

Phase	Timing	Key Investments
Optimize current kitchen	0–6 months	Equipment upgrades, workflow efficiency, inventory system
Expand packaged product capacity	6–12 months	Dedicated packaging equipment, KEBS certification for SKUs
Delivery infrastructure	6–12 months	Partner with delivery platforms (Glovo, Bolt), hire delivery riders
Second location or larger kitchen	18–36 months	Expand capacity for growing demand
Dedicated production facility (packaged)	24–36 months	Separate manufacturing for ugali/uji blends at scale

7.3 Supply Chain

Ingredient	Source	Notes
Finger millet, sorghum	Local farmers (Western/Rift Valley)	~52,000 tonnes national production (KNBS 2023)
Plantain	Western Kenya / Uganda	Key input for kvass — reliable supply
Goat milk	Local dairy farmers	Sourced fresh
Rabbit, turkey	Specialty farmers, Nairobi region	Unconventional proteins — smaller supply base
Spices & seasonings	Local markets + importers	Widely available
Packaging materials	Nairobi suppliers	Multiple options available

7.4 Quality Assurance

- **Founder is a trained food scientist** — quality is embedded in the business DNA
- HACCP principles applied in kitchen operations
- KEBS certification to be pursued for packaged products (estimated timeline: 57 days per product)
- Customer feedback loop via social media enables rapid quality adjustments

8. MANAGEMENT & ORGANIZATION

8.1 Founder Profile

Prisca Kiragu — Founder & CEO

- **Education:** Food Science, Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT)
- **Expertise:** Food formulation, fermentation science, nutritional product development
- **Role:** Product development, kitchen operations, marketing (social media/reels), business strategy
- **Recognition:** Featured in JHUB Africa Innovatech (agribusiness innovation)
- **Online presence:** Active on Instagram (@priscakiragu) and TikTok (@priscakiragu) with cooking demos and food science education

8.2 Key Hiring Needs (Next 12 Months)

Role	Priority	Purpose
Kitchen Manager / Head Chef	High	Free founder for strategy and product development
Sales & Marketing Coordinator	High	Manage social media, delivery platform listings, customer acquisition
Delivery Rider(s)	Medium	Scale delivery coverage in Nairobi
Production Assistant	Medium	Scale packaged product production
Part-time Accountant	Medium	Financial management and tax compliance

8.3 Advisory Needs

Expertise	Purpose
Retail/FMCG distribution	Navigate supermarket listings and retail partnerships
Food industry investor	Access to funding networks and strategic guidance
Digital marketing	Scale social media and e-commerce efficiently
Regulatory/KEBS	Expedite certifications for packaged products

9. FINANCIAL PLAN

9.1 Current Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Est. Contribution	Avg. Transaction
Restaurant meals (walk-in)	50–60%	KES 500–900
Delivery orders (WhatsApp/phone)	20–30%	KES 600–1,200
Packaged products (local + parcels)	10–15%	KES 250–600
Beverages	Included in above	KES 100–300

9.2 Projected Growth

Metric	Year 1 (Current)	Year 2	Year 3	Year 5
Monthly Revenue (KES)	300K–500K (est.)	1.0–2.0M	3.0–5.5M	10–17M
Annual Revenue (KES M)	3.6–6.0	12–24	36–66	120–200
Gross Margin	55–65%	58–68%	60–70%	62–72%
Revenue Channels	3 (restaurant, delivery, parcels)	5 (+platforms, supermarkets)	6 (+e-commerce)	8+ (+export, franchise)
Team Size	3–5	10–15	20–30	50–80

9.3 Unit Economics

Product	Selling Price	Est. COGS	Est. Gross Margin
Average meal combo	KES 650	KES 250–300	54–62%
Plantain kvass (per serving)	KES 150–250	KES 40–70	70–75%
Ugali blend (packaged)	KES 250	KES 80–100	60–68%
Uji blend (packaged)	KES 600	KES 180–220	63–70%

Key insight: Packaged products and beverages have **higher margins** than ready meals — scaling these increases overall profitability.

9.4 Funding Use Summary

Use	Amount (KES)	Priority
Kitchen equipment upgrades	500K–1M	High
KEBS certification (packaged products)	200K–500K	High
Packaging design and production	300K–600K	High
Marketing and brand building	500K–1M	High
Website and e-commerce setup	100K–200K	Done (website built)
Working capital (3–6 months)	1M–2M	High
Delivery infrastructure	200K–500K	Medium
Team hiring	500K–1M	Medium
Total Phase 1 Need	KES 3.3–6.8M	

10. RISK ANALYSIS & MITIGATION

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Slow customer growth	Medium	High	Strengthen social media, list on delivery platforms, sampling events
Cash flow constraints	Medium	High	Maintain cash reserve, pursue grant funding, phase investments
Supply chain disruption (rabbit, plantain)	Medium	Medium	Multiple suppliers, recipe flexibility, alternative ingredients
Competition enters health food niche	Medium	Medium	First-mover advantage, founder expertise, brand loyalty, continuous innovation
Food safety incident	Low	Very High	Food scientist founder, HACCP protocols, insurance, rapid response plan
Key person risk (founder)	Medium	High	Hire kitchen manager, document all recipes/processes, build team
Regulatory changes	Low	Medium	KEBS compliance, KAM membership, monitor policy
Ingredient cost inflation	Medium	Medium	Menu price adjustments, alternative sourcing, bulk purchasing
Location risk (lease)	Low	High	Long-term lease negotiation, explore second location options

11. GROWTH ROADMAP

Phase 1: Strengthen & Systemize (0–12 Months)

- Optimize kitchen operations for efficiency and consistency
- Complete KEBS certification for packaged products
- Launch on Glovo and Bolt Food delivery platforms
- Build website into full e-commerce channel with M-Pesa
- Hire kitchen manager and marketing coordinator
- Reach KES 1M+/month revenue

Phase 2: Scale Distribution (12–24 Months)

- List packaged products in Quickmatt and 2–3 supermarket chains
- Launch bottled plantain kvass and synbiotic porridge sachets
- Open 2nd service point or expand to larger kitchen
- Build corporate wellness client base
- Achieve KES 3–5M/month revenue

Phase 3: Market Leadership (24–36 Months)

- 20–50 supermarket listings for packaged products
- Explore franchise model for restaurant concept
- Pilot export to East African markets (Uganda, Tanzania)
- Launch diaspora e-commerce (D2C international shipping)
- Achieve KES 8–15M/month revenue

Phase 4: National & Regional Brand (36–60 Months)

- Multiple restaurant locations across Nairobi
- Full national retail distribution for packaged products
- EAC export expansion
- Product range of 40+ SKUs
- Revenue target: KES 120–200M annually

12. FUNDING REQUIREMENTS

12.1 Immediate Need (Phase 1)

KES 3.3–6.8 million (~USD 25,000–53,000)

For: Equipment upgrades, KEBS certification, packaging, marketing, working capital, team hiring.

12.2 Growth Capital (Phase 2, Year 2)

KES 10–20 million (~USD 78,000–155,000)

For: Retail expansion, new product launches (bottled kvass, porridge sachets), delivery fleet, marketing scale-up, second location exploration.

12.3 Funding Sources to Pursue

Source	Amount	Suitability
Grants (priority):		
Tony Elumelu Foundation	USD 5,000 + mentorship	High — agribusiness focus
HealthyDiets4Africa Accelerator	Varies	High — nutrition/food systems
Kenya Climate Innovation Center	Up to KES 5M	Medium — sustainable food
County Youth/Women Enterprise Funds	KES 500K–2M	Medium
Angel Investors:		
Kenya Angel Investors Network	KES 2–10M	High — food-tech interest
Viktoria Ventures	Varies	Medium
Debt/Microfinance:		
SME bank loans (KCB, Equity)	KES 1–5M	Medium — collateral needed
Microfinance (Faulu, KWFT)	KES 100K–1M	Accessible
Competitions:		
JHUB Africa Innovatech	Varies	Already recognized here
Hult Prize / Anzisha Prize	Varies	High visibility

This business plan was prepared for Ayola Foods Limited. Financial projections are based on estimated current operations and reasonable growth assumptions. All market data has been fact-checked against verified sources (see Market Research Report for full citations).

End of Business Plan